

Students should have an understanding of:

1.1	The nature of the Almighty: how the characteristics of the Almighty are shown in the Torah, and why they are important in Jewish life today, including One, Creator, Law-Giver and Judge, including reference to Genesis 2.
1.2	The nature and importance of Shekhinah: how the divine presence is shown in the Torah and why it is important including interpretations of 2 Chronicles 7:1–3; the divergent understandings of Shekhinah found in different forms of Orthodox Judaism and the importance of them for Jews today.
1.3	The nature and purpose of the Messiah: how messiahship is shown in the scriptures, including Jeremiah 23:5–8; the nature and significance of the Messianic Age and the Jewish responsibility to bring it about; divergent understandings of the Messiah in different forms of Orthodox and Reform Judaism and the importance of them for Jewish people today.
1.4	The covenant with Abraham and his descendants: the nature and history of the Abrahamic covenant; the role of Abraham in the covenant, including Genesis 17; why the Promised Land covenanted to Abraham and his descendants is important for Jews today.
1.5	The Covenant at Sinai: the nature and history of the Covenant at Sinai (the Ten Commandments), including Exodus 20; the role and significance of Moses in the Covenant at Sinai; divergent understandings of how and why the Decalogue is important in Jewish life today.
1.6	Sanctity of life: why human life is holy for Jewish people; how life is shown as special. The nature and importance of Pikuach Nefesh (primacy of life): life takes precedence over everything, with reference to Talmud Yoma 83–84; divergent understandings of how and why the principle of Pikuach Nefesh is applied by Jews today.
1.7	Moral principles and the Mitzvot: the nature and importance of the Mitzvot, including reference to the Mishneh Torah of Maimonides: Sefer Madda; the importance of the relationship between keeping the Mitzvot and free will; the Mitzvot between humans and the Almighty, and between humans; divergent understandings of the importance of the Mitzvot between the Almighty and humans, and between humans, for Jewish life today.
1.8*	Jewish beliefs about life after death: divergent Jewish understandings of the nature and significance of life after death including reference to different forms of Orthodox and Reform Judaism; Jewish teachings about life after death including interpretations of Ecclesiastes 12; the nature of resurrection and judgement; why belief in life after death may be important for Jews today.

Students should have an understanding of:

2.1	The importance and purpose of marriage for Jews: Jewish teachings about the importance and purpose of marriage in Jewish life, including Proverbs 18.22; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to the importance of marriage in society, including a lack of importance, cohabitation and the Jewish responses to them.
2.2	Jewish teachings about the nature and importance of sexual relationships: Jewish teachings about sexual relationships, including Genesis 1:26–31 and Song of Songs; divergent Jewish teachings and attitudes towards sexual relationships outside of marriage and same-sex sexual relationships; different non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to sexual relationships, including the acceptance of sexual relationships outside marriage and same-sex sexual relationships and Jewish responses to them.
2.3	Jewish teachings about the purpose and importance of the family: Jewish teachings about the purpose of family – procreation; security and education of children with reference to Psalm 127:3–5; divergent Jewish and non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) responses to the purpose of the family; different types of family within 21st-century society (nuclear, single parent, same-sex parents, extended and blended families).
2.4	Support for the family in the Jewish community: how and why the local community tries to support families, including through family worship, rites of passage, classes for parents, groups for children and counselling, with reference to Talmud Bava Batra 21a–b; the importance of the support of the local Jewish community for Jews today.
2.5	Jewish teaching about family planning and regulation of births: divergent Jewish teachings and attitudes about contraception and family planning, including reference to the Talmud, Yevamot 61b; different non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to family planning and the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Jewish responses to them.
2.6	Jewish teachings and attitudes towards divorce and remarriage: divergent Jewish teachings about divorce and remarriage, including reference to Maimonides, Mishneh Torah, Ishut 24 and arguments used to support or reject divorce; Jewish, non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to divorce and remarriage, including the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Jewish responses to them.
2.7	Jewish teachings and attitudes about the equality of men and women in the family: Jewish teachings and attitudes about the equality and roles of men and women in the family, including reference to Genesis 1:26–31; divergent Jewish attitudes about the roles of men and women in the family and Jewish responses to them.
2.8	Jewish teachings about gender prejudice and discrimination: Jewish opposition to gender prejudice and discrimination, including The Basic Law: Human Dignity and Liberty (1992 The Knesset); examples of gender equality in action in Judaism.